

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-vom2-wykd
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-3633

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

The technology industry has a long history of preempting any regulations that may stifle its opportunistic growth, and AI is simply the latest in a long string of dubious fads it's embraced in the pursuit of said growth. These systems already consume inordinate amounts of energy, fresh water, and real estate, all to provide highly questionable utility, inconsistent (and often flat-out wrong) output, and no profit whatsoever; it's a game of chicken, where they're hoping we (the taxpayers) will blink before they're forced to reconcile with the costs and (lack of) returns on investments.

Something America has always been a champion of is intellectual property rights. If you write an award-winning novel, you're entitled to the proceeds. If you create a hit piece of music, you're entitled to the proceeds. If you create a new product, a popular movie, a hit TV Show, or a revolutionary medicine, you're entitled to the proceeds of your work. It's a fundamental law that has made America the global epicenter of culture, media, and creativity. What these AI companies have done is build their products off the infinite creativity and labor of Americans and humans all over the world, all throughout history, to build glorified prediction machines they claim can replace labor and revolutionize humanity - yet have presently done neither, after several years of existence and availability. These models relied on the largest organized theft in human history, stealing music, books, movies, stories, news articles, paintings, and more, without a single cent paid to their creators or permission ever asked for. Now they seek forgiveness for this theft after the fact, instead of proper permission and licensing for the data they used before engaging in theft. They seek to manipulate the US Government into granting this forgiveness under the guise of "National Security", despite a complete lack of such a threat.

Granting these companies their desire to ignore copyright laws would single-handedly doom the American economy and cripple our already-tattered global reputation. Hollywood would disappear, unable to trust America to uphold its investment into films and television. Copyright enforcement would shift from America to other countries, further weakening our global hegemony and letting them set the rules that we'll have to abide by. In fact, granting these companies a permission to steal effectively places us in the same cohort as China, another country that routinely fails to respect intellectual property rights and steals from American creators.

If these AI companies truly cannot exist without these large sources of information, and if their products are truly as valuable as they claim, then they can easily afford to license the works used in training from the original creators, at whatever rates the creators demand. The harsh reality is that these products aren't profitable, and aren't valuable, and that holding these companies accountable for their original thefts would bankrupt them - not just in America, but globally as well.

The right thing to do is to protect the talent that makes the American economy so great and diverse in the first place, that makes it the creative capitol of the world that everyone seeks to replicate and copy. If that means bankrupting AI companies through onerous copyright penalties for using stolen content, then so be it - because at least then, we're forcing everyone to play on the same field as us, rather than gladly surrendering our creativity to others.

Reject the tech industry's attempt to gut America in the name of an unproven fad. Protect copyright, and protect the people.